

Useful Resources in the Application Process

With VICTOR MUTINDA



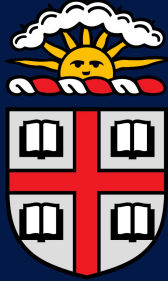


What kind of resources do you need?

1. College search
2. Essay writing
3. SAT preparation
4. Applying to schools
5. Personal development
6. Caring for your Mental Health

College Research:

How do you find the best college for you?



College Research:

1. School websites

- a. School profile
- b. Majors
- c. Research opportunities
- d. Extracurricular activities
- e. Financial aid application
- f. AOs' contacts
- g. Acceptance rate
- h. Social life
- i. **ACTUAL FACTS!**



VIRGINIA COMMONWEALTH UNIVERSITY

Make it real. Give to VCU ♥

MYVCU REGISTER FOR CLASSES CURRENT STUDENTS FACULTY AND STAFF PARENTS AND FAMILIES ALUMNI PATIENTS COMMUNITY

VCU ACADEMICS ADMISSIONS & AID LIFE AT VCU RESEARCH ARTS ATHLETICS ABOUT US

APPLY VISIT PROGRAMS

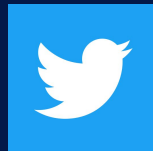
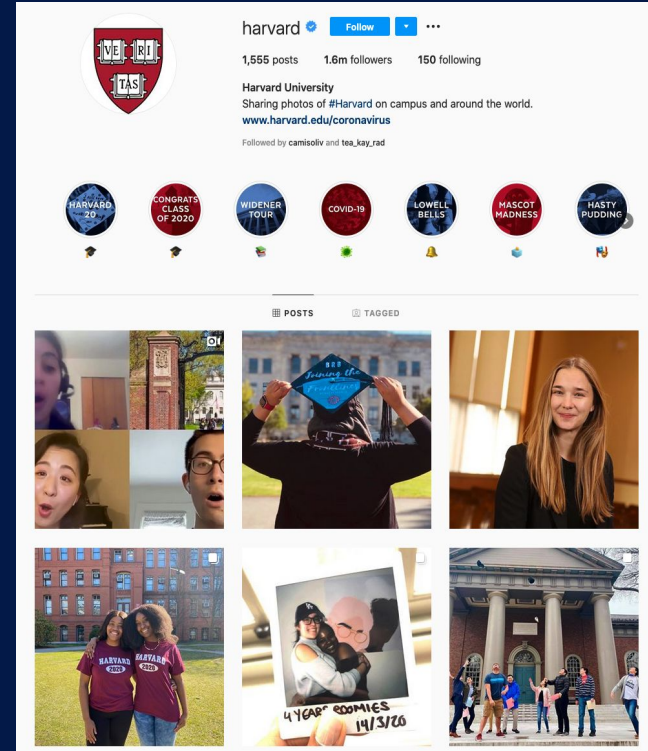
VIRTUAL
May commencement
Join graduates, families and friends on May 15 for a 9 a.m. Zoom pre-party followed by the universitywide virtual commencement ceremony at 10 a.m.
[Read more >](#)

A collage of photos showing diverse students and graduates, including a group of students, a student with a dog, a student holding a red apple, a student in a graduation cap, and a student in a graduation gown.

College Research:

2. Official Social Media Accounts (Instagram, TikTok, Twitter, etc)

- The community
- School vibe
- Get updates



College Research:

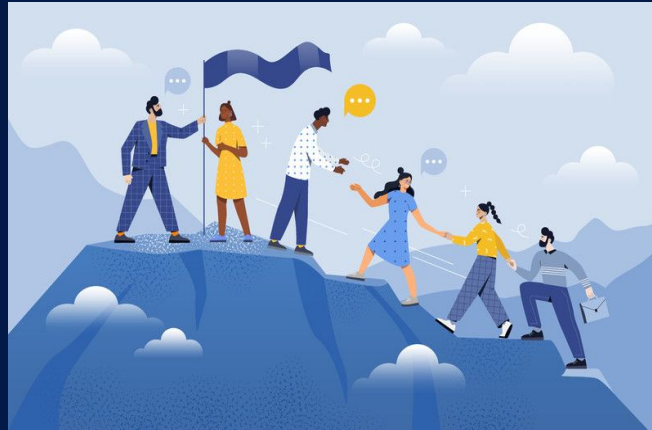
3. Reaching out to current/past students

- a. Get first hand information on the school community
- b. Better way to find out whether you will fit in

a. Kenyan global scholars



b. ECC mentors



c. Youtube vloggers



College Research:



4. Make good use of Google, Reddit, Quora and Unigo.

- Encounter real student opinions and experiences
- Find 'hidden' information about the schools
- Offers a productive way to take a break from the application stress
- Supplement the facts from the schools websites
- Learn stereotypes associated with the schools

Quora

Posted by u/GoldenLinked · HS Grad · 7 months ago

UF decisions come out at 6PM EST today!

54 Comments · Give Award · Share · Save · Hide · Report

This thread is archived
New comments cannot be posted and votes cannot be cast

SORT BY: BEST · Single comment thread. View all comments

mnmkmm · 6 points · 7 months ago

Will it be on the normal site or will it be an email

Give Award · Share · Report · Save

FloridaGuy83 · Verified Admissions Officer · 10 points · 7 months ago

It'll be through your application status on the website.

Give Award · Share · Report · Save

ajearth · 3 points · 7 months ago

Unrelated but does the music dept communicate with your office? I already got my scholarship letter for music!

Give Award · Share · Report · Save

FloridaGuy83 · Verified Admissions Officer · 3 points · 7 months ago

They do, depending on the situation. I know the College of the Arts sometimes sends out those scholarship notifications early, however I just want you to know that it is not equivalent to an admission offer. I believe the letter states somewhere that you can receive the scholarship if you are admitted.

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Quora

Create Space

College Admissions

Master of Science in...

Studying Abroad

International Students

Colleges and...

College Advice

College and University...

David S. Rose · Follow

Studied at Yale University · 11mo

Why would someone choose to go to UC Berkeley instead of Harvard, Yale, or Brown?

As my daughter said when we visited Berkeley on a college scouting trip from our home in New York... "The weather is always like this...and it's 3,000 miles from my parents?!" ...

(more)

Upvote · 1.5K · 54 · 20

Ryan Reich · Follow

Ph.D in Mathematics, Harvard University · 8y

How does Harvard compare to the University of Chicago for an undergraduate studying mathematics?

I was an undergraduate at Chicago and a grad student at Harvard, both for math, so I guess I can answer this.

Chicago has a fantastic math program: not only do they nominally offer a full and complete selection of undergraduate classes, many of which are at a graduate level, but these classes are for real, with regularly good enrollment. It's the kind of math program that only a small number of math departments can offer, because Chicago has (for real) 10% of its undergraduates doing math.

There are a lot of talented math students at Chicago and this means that you can be really immersed in the subject. When I was there, they also had a thing called the Directed Reading Program where you could study with graduate students in a kind of mini-reading course. The summer REU is more of a math camp with lots of eclectic courses (for example, I was in one where Peter May lectured on finite homotopy types, right at the point where he first became interested in the subject).

In total, Chicago is a place where you can get a great structured education and take advantage of a bunch of opportunities to move beyond it.

At Harvard I got the feeling (from more of a distance, since I was not actually an undergraduate) that you were *expected* to break the mold of their course structure. The very best students there seemed uniformly to be doing research at a very early stage in their career, forming relationships with professors that were actually...

Upvote · 138 · 1 · 5

Essay Writing:

With the acceptance rates dropping by every year, the essays are becoming a huge part application. It's your chance to actually convince the Admissions Officers why they should pick you.

Other than the main essay (personal statement), you'll probably have to write more essays each with their own structure.

- a. Additional Information/Gap year/Covid-19 essay
- b. Why school/major essay
- c. Argumentative/intellectual vitality/short-response/extracurricular activity/community service essay

Essay Writing:

1. ECC Mentors - A reliable source to review and guide you in your essays, and virtually every part of your application.
2. [ECC Resource Drive](#) - plenty of resource materials that are helpful in your essays, and whole app.



Essay Writing:

School podcasts:

1. *Get the real information from the actual admission officer on what they look for in applications.*

[Inside the Yale Admissions Office Podcast](#)

[Dartmouth Podcast](#)

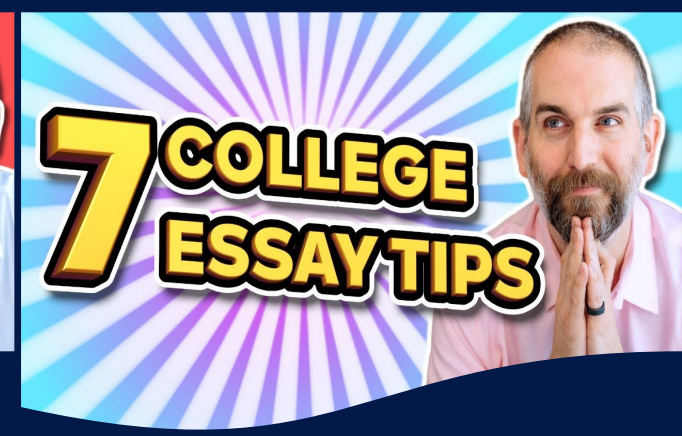
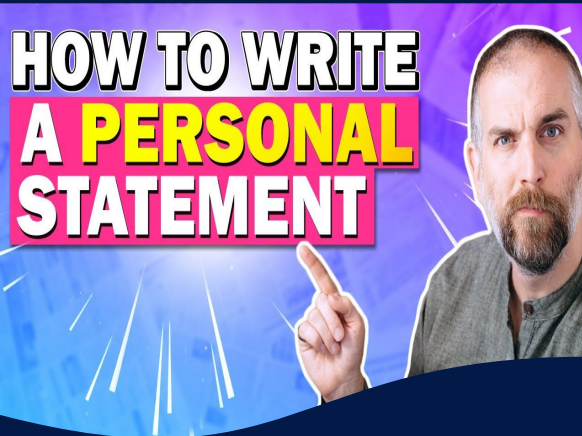
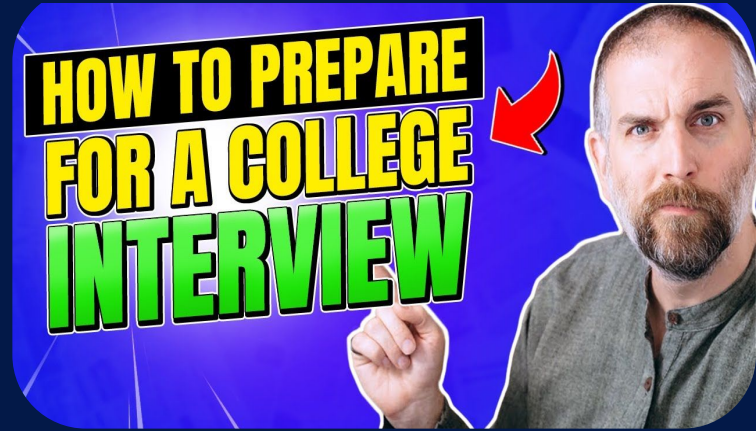


Essay Writing:

College Essay Guy

Helps students find their voice and tell their stories in the most captivating way.

He also offers sessions to review your work if interested.



Essay Writing:

There are also so many sites that offer advice and guides on the essays and so much more on the whole application process:

- a. [PrepScholar](#)
- b. [Collegevine](#)
- c. [College Essay Advisors](#)
- d. [Crimson Education](#)
- e. [Shemmassian Academic Consulting](#)
- f. [Koppelman Group](#)
- g. [Ingenius Prep](#)
- h. [Ivy Wise](#)
- i. [Ivy Scholars](#)
- j. [Essays That Worked](#)

- ❖ Some schools provide examples of essays that worked for current students on their websites:
 - 1. Tufts
 - 2. Johns Hopkins university
 - 3. Uchicago

Essay Writing:

Sandra Mwangi's Youtube videos

A lot of content on various aspects of the application which is all very specific to Kenyan/African students.

- a. Essays
- b. Extracurricular activities
- c. SAT



Essay Writing:

GRAMMARLY - makes sure everything you type not only upholds accurate spelling, punctuation, and grammar, but is also clear, compelling, and easy to read.

QUILLBOT - a paraphrasing and summarizing tool that helps millions of students and professionals cut their writing time by more than half using state-of-the-art AI to rewrite any sentence, paragraph, or article

DESCRIPTIONARI - Helps you get a description of the scenarios you want to paint a picture on. You need to type the word you want to describe then give you the descriptions you will use to describe that word i.e describing how sunny it was.

SAT PREPARATION:

Some schools are picking up the mandatory testing policy.

NB: If MIT is your dream school, then you have to take the test (AND GET A GOOD SCORE!).



As much as the SAT is optional in some schools, it may boost the stats of your application. Especially when you score high.

SAT PREPARATION:

The only hack to the SAT is a lot of practice.

Mentors are also available to help.



The [ECC Resource Drive](#) contains a lot of SAT resources that will help you to cover all the topics covered in the test.

APPLYING TO COLLEGES:



APPLYING TO COLLEGES:

- ❖ **The Common Application** - The platform where you will make your application to most colleges in the US
- ❖ **My MIT** - The exclusive site to apply to MIT
- ❖ **The College Board** - Submitting the CSS Profile, registering for the SAT, accessing the Bluebook.

Personal Development:



The application process will ask you to do a lot of soul searching, and therefore in the process, you will discover things about yourself that you may have not known.

Personal Development:

1. Research your field so you get conversant with the technical terms and everything it's all about.
2. Get involved in your intended field(s) of study
- Engage in community projects, individual start-ups, talk to people currently in the said field(s).
3. Find a peer-advisor - A fellow scholar who will help you in your application, and hold you accountable.



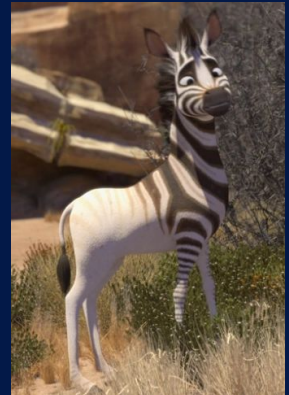
Personal Development:

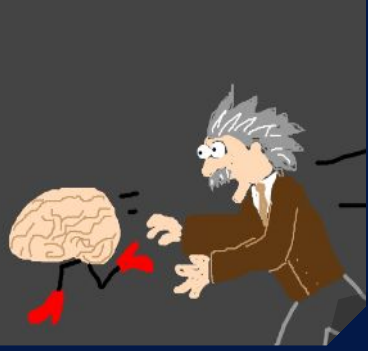
Books: The Power of Now, Animal Farm, Atomic Habits, Crime and Punishment, Pride and Prejudice, Think and Grow Rich, Rich Dad Poor Dad, Born a Crime.

Movies: Khumba, Hidden Figures, Inception, Interstellar, Life of Pi, Fight club, 7 deadly sins, The Truman show, Pursuit of Happiness, Shawshank Redemption, Marshall.

Series: Mindhunter, Dark, Sherlock, Black Mirror, When They See Us, 7 seconds

Relevant Documentaries: (Youtube/Netflix)





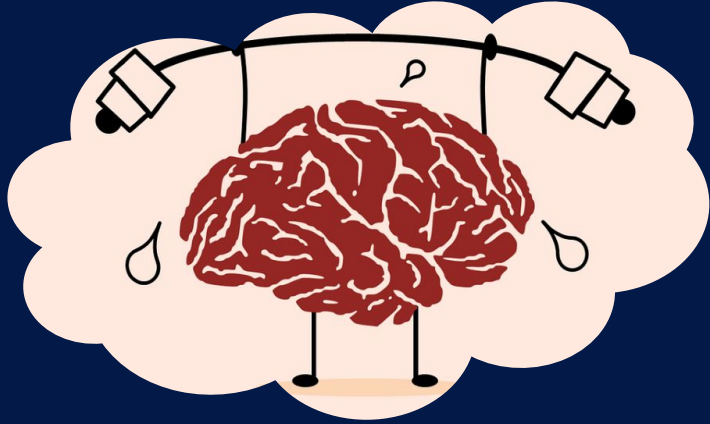
Caring for your Mental Health:

The application process is very demanding. It gets overwhelming and may induce:

- a. Stress
- b. Anxiety
- c. Restlessness
- d. Depression
- e. Lack of motivation



Caring for your Mental Health:



- a. Talk to your mentor - they have experienced the same process.
- b. Reach out to Ms. Beverly - will get you professional help when necessary
- c. Take a breather - Exercise, Participate in community activities

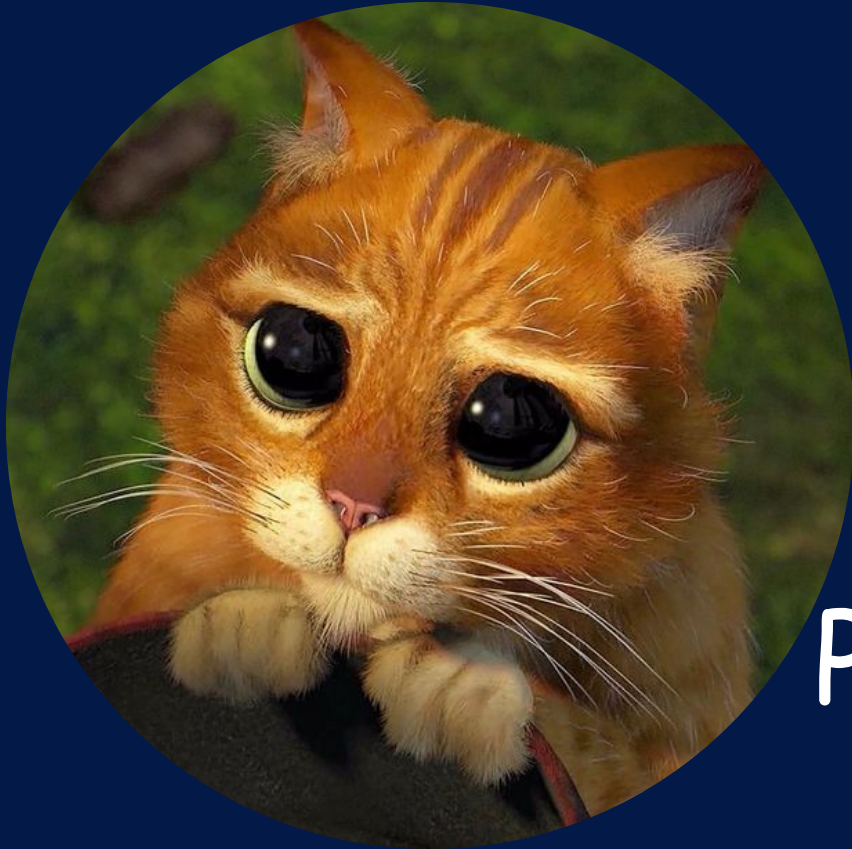
- d. Appreciate yourself - Compare & despair is a dangerous game.
- e. Find good/supportive friends to keep you motivated.



ANY QUESTIONS?



THANK YOU!



Please clap now.